

Deep Focus from Home — 7-Day Starter Pack

Phone rule: Plan the day first. During the deep-work block, park the phone off your desk. Check messages between blocks.

Day 1: Workspace

Job: Claim one surface that is work-only.

Why: When the same table is dining, couch desk, and office, the brain never gets a clean start cue.

- Pick the exact surface you will use for the next seven workdays.
- Clear everything that is not work.
- For the first deep-work block, park the phone (another room or off the desk).
- When you finish, close the space — do not linger there.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 2: Household

Job: Set one visible do-not-disturb signal.

Why: People at home treat physical presence as availability. A signal they can see is kinder than a lecture.

- Name your core hours out loud to anyone who shares the space.
- Choose a signal a child could understand (door, headphones, card).
- Agree what counts as an emergency.
- Write one rule: chores wait for a break.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 3: Digital

Job: Park the phone for the first deep-work block.

Why: Plan the day first. Then, for the block itself, the phone leaves your desk. Some research suggests a phone in view can pull at your attention, even on silent. Out of sight beats willpower.

- Write today's 1–3 outcomes, then start the block.
- Then put the phone away for 60–90 minutes (another room, or face-down off the desk).
- Need a timer? Use a kitchen timer or a clock, not the phone.
- Between blocks, pick two short windows to check messages.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 4: Rituals

Job: Write a morning start and a shutdown.

Why: Rituals replace willpower. The same five minutes every day tell the brain when work begins and ends.

- Write a 5–7 minute morning sequence.

- Clear the surface. Write 1–3 outcomes. Start the first block.
- Write a 5-minute shutdown: mark what finished, capture tomorrow, leave.
- Run both for five workdays before changing them.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 5: Blocks

Job: Protect two deep-work sessions on the calendar.

Why: A block that is not on the calendar is a wish. Treat it as immovable.

- Choose two 60–90 minute windows for the next five workdays.
- Put them on the calendar with a start and an end.
- At the end of each, write one sentence about what you finished.
- If the day is wrecked, keep a 15-minute minimum. Do not cancel the streak.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 6: People

Job: Add one accountability loop.

Why: Home has no passive social pressure. One person who knows the plan is enough.

- Name one accountability partner.
- Send them today's 1–3 outcomes before you start.
- Schedule one body-doubling or coworking session.
- Keep the message short. Do not wait for the perfect person.

■ I completed today's job.

Day 7: Energy

Job: Find your peak window. Plan next week there.

Why: Focus follows energy. Heroic blocks in a trough are how people quit the system.

- Look back over the last few days (your one-line notes, or memory). When did focus feel easiest?
- Name your strongest two-hour window.
- Put next week's hardest work inside it.
- Take one genuine outdoor or movement break this afternoon.

■ I completed today's job.

Daily check (after Day 3): Phone parked for the block (off desk / out of reach).